

RULE THE BOARD

2025-26 IMPACT REPORT

EXCELLENCE • PASSION • RESILIENCE • INTEGRITY • SERVICE



MESSAGE FROM OUR FOUNDERS

Dear friends and supporters,

One year ago, Rule the Board emerged from the realization that so many kids are eager to learn, grow, and excel in chess but lack the resources and support to do so. Since then, countless hours of teaching, thousands of puzzles solved, and a multitude of chess matches have created an inquisitive and collaborative community of chess scholars.



We've also worked to instill and embody five core values: excellence, resilience, integrity, passion, and service. Additionally, we have built a strong organizational foundation to ensure that Rule the Board's positive impact continues well into the future as our team and the program grows/expands. Our team has already welcomed four new administrative members and two additional coaches. Together, we are shaping the futures of our scholars, families, and communities.

Next, we would like to take a moment to recognize the impact that Rule the Board has had on a personal level for our students. The progress we have witnessed extends far beyond ratings and results: our scholars are more confident, resilient, and thorough. They have learned more than chess; they have practiced how to approach challenges with patience and carry themselves with integrity. They have grown in more ways than we can count and inspire us to continue creating a meaningful impact.

We are so excited for what's to come, and we encourage you to join us on this journey!

With Gratitude,
Nathan, Leonardo, and Arjun

MISSION

Empower students to pursue their passion for chess through high-quality instruction and opportunities.

VISION

Build a nationwide, tight-knit chess community where every student has the opportunity to discover the joy of learning, playing, and growing through chess.

PURPOSE

Uplift learners from marginalized communities by encouraging discipline, critical thinking, resilience, and other principles that are highly valuable in all areas of life.

YEAR IN REVIEW

The Rule the Board Scholarship is a rigorous program that provides chess resources to exceptional students who have embodied Rule the Board's core values of excellence, resilience, integrity, passion, and service. Scholars pursue their passion in chess, developing life skills such as perseverance, collaboration, and critical thinking.

Throughout the year, our scholars received:

- Weekly office hours for practice & questions
- Weekly virtual lessons from chess experts
- Entry to the Emory Castle Chess Grand Prix
- Professional chess set
- USCF membership



7492

Puzzles Completed

936

Games Played

212

Lesson Time Hours

4

Inaugural Scholars

1961

Highest Scholar Rating

CHECKMATE YOUR SUMMER

Hosted at Odyssey Atlanta, Checkmate Your Summer is an immersive program that provides chess materials and brings the world of chess to Odyssey scholars through lessons, coaching, and tournaments. With our team of student volunteer coaches, Rule the Board fostered a drive for learning, critical thinking, and collaboration in over 40 scholars.

261

Vounteer Hours

40+

Scholars Served



IMPACT HIGHLIGHTS

EMORY GRAND PRIX TOURNAMENT

By covering entry fees into tournaments, we exposed our scholars to an elite competitive chess environment. During the tournament, scholars were able to showcase their skills and improvement, with one of our scholars defeating a 1000 USCF-rated player.



Another one of our scholars used this opportunity to meet and play an unofficial game against the highest-rated player in the state, who recently defeated the world's second-best player, Hikaru Nakamura.



*“The tournament gave my scholar the opportunity to apply the skills he has developed and **build confidence** in a competitive setting.”*

-Rule the Board Parent



*“It was fun but difficult at the same time, and even when losing, **you can always learn something.**”*

-Rule the Board Scholar

OUTLOOK

Our team has grown to nine members, and we aim to inspire more volunteers and coaches to join Rule the Board. A first step in our growth was doubling our impact from four inaugural students to eight this upcoming year, and our goal is to continue supporting as many students as possible. In order to pursue our vision of a nationwide community, we are extending our reach to more areas in which Rule the Board can provide the benefits of chess, bridging the gap between potential and opportunity.

*“Rule the Board taught me to
have a strategy and plan
before everything I do.”*

-Rule the Board Scholar



Scholars who have graduated from Rule the Board are forever a part of our community, and part of our dream is to foster a robust network of Rule the Board students, trainers, and alumni. To achieve this, we are working toward hosting our own chess tournament. This tournament will allow scholars to practice in a competitive environment, connect with alumni, and celebrate their achievements.



THANK YOU

We truly appreciate our partners, funders, and volunteers for supporting us with their resources, energy, and time. You enable Rule the Board to continue making a positive impact in Atlanta with the best possible chess education.

OUR PARTNERS



GLENN INSTITUTE

WESTMINSTER



A quest for knowledge | A path through college

OUR TEAM

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To volunteer, contribute, or for more information,
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